

The 3-2-1 backup rule is a widely accepted best practice for backup and recovery that provides a simple and effective way to ensure data protection and recoverability. It consists of three rules:

1. Keep at least three copies of your data: This means having the original data plus two additional copies stored in different locations. This provides redundancy and ensures that data is available even if one copy is lost or inaccessible.
2. Store your data in at least two different formats: This means having multiple copies of your data stored in different formats, such as a combination of hard drives, tapes, or cloud storage. This provides protection against technology failures or obsolescence.
3. Keep at least one copy of your data offsite: This means having a backup copy of your data stored in a location separate from your primary data center or office. This provides protection against physical disasters, theft, or other events that could affect the primary data center.

By following the 3-2-1 backup rule, organizations can ensure that their data is protected and recoverable in the event of a disaster, whether it's a natural disaster, cyberattack, hardware failure, or human error. It provides a simple and effective framework for backup and recovery planning and helps to minimize the risk of data loss and downtime.